



QMS-006 — Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery Plan

Overleaf Publishers Ltd · Co. No. 15735226 · VAT No. 479581629 · Version 1.0 · July 2026 · chainsawcourses.com

1. PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVES

This plan ensures that Overleaf Publishers Ltd can maintain, restore, and recover critical business functions and the Chainsaw Courses platform following a disruptive event. Document reference: QMS-006.

Objectives: maintain learner access to course content with minimum disruption; protect learner and business data from permanent loss; restore full platform functionality within defined recovery timescales; and ensure regulatory and contractual obligations continue to be met during and after a disruption.

2. RECOVERY OBJECTIVES

METRIC	TARGET
Recovery Time Objective (RTO) — time to restore critical systems	"d4 hours for platform availability; "d24 hours for full functionality
Recovery Point Objective (RPO) — maximum data loss acceptable	"d24 hours (daily backup minimum; continuous where available)
Maximum Tolerable Downtime (MTD)	72 hours — beyond this, learner notifications and regulatory obligations are triggered

3. BUSINESS IMPACT ANALYSIS

BUSINESS FUNCTION (CRITICALITY)	IMPACT OF DISRUPTION
Learner platform access — course content, quizzes, progress (Critical)	Loss of service to paying learners; reputational damage; potential refund obligation
Activation code system (Critical)	New learners cannot activate; existing learners may lose device bond
Learner data — progress, waiver, inspection records (Critical)	Data loss violates UK GDPR; loss of evidence for IIRSM compliance
Payment processing — Shopify/Stripe (High)	Loss of new revenue; handled by third-party providers with their own BCPs
Admin dashboard (High)	Director cannot manage learner records or generate compliance documents
AI mock examiner (Medium)	Degrades gracefully to keyword-based fallback; not safety-critical
Email and learner communications (Medium)	Delay in support responses; notifications delayed but catchable

PDF generation — waivers,
inspection reports (Medium)

Records cannot be generated; learner data still preserved in database

4. THREAT SCENARIOS AND RESPONSE

THREAT	RESPONSE
Cloud hosting outage (Replit) — short-duration (<4 hours)	1. Check status.replit.com to confirm it is a platform-side outage. 2. Do not attempt code changes during the outage. 3. Post a learner-facing status update if access is affected. 4. Platform restores automatically on provider recovery; no infrastructure action required. 5. Log incident in the admin dashboard once resolved.
Cloud hosting outage (Replit) — extended (>4 hours or provider SLA breached)	1. Notify active learners by email within 4 hours with an estimated resolution timeline. 2. Retrieve learner data from the most recent weekly Google Sheet export (stored in Google Drive). 3. Evaluate temporary alternative hosting (e.g. Render, Railway) using the codebase pushed to a third-party Git repository. 4. If Replit resumes, restore to primary hosting. 5. If migration required, update DNS/domain and redeploy from Git. Estimated RTO for migration: "d8 hours.
Replit permanent shutdown or account loss	Learner data is preserved in weekly Google Sheet exports. Codebase is recoverable from Git history (push repository to GitHub or GitLab as an offline copy — do this now if not yet done). Redeploy to alternative host (Render, Railway, Fly.io) using the same environment variables. Estimated RTO: "d24 hours. Activate learner communication plan immediately.
Database corruption or accidental deletion	Restore from most recent Replit-managed database backup (accessible via Replit dashboard 'Database' Backups). Verify data integrity post-restoration using the Google Sheet export as a reference. Log data loss period and notify affected learners if personal data impacted.
Ransomware or malicious compromise	Isolate affected systems immediately. Activate Data Breach and Incident Response Procedure. Restore from last known clean backup. Engage specialist incident response if required. Notify ICO if personal data involved within 72 hours.
Accidental code deployment causing platform failure	Rollback to last stable checkpoint via Replit's built-in checkpoint history. If Replit is inaccessible, redeploy from Git. Estimated recovery: "d2 hours.
Loss of key personnel (sole director incapacity)	Emergency contact and succession brief held by a nominated trusted person. Access to critical credentials via a secure, pre-arranged process (sealed envelope or password manager emergency access). Escalate to professional advisor if extended incapacity.

Third-party video platform (Vimeo) outage	Notify learners via platform banner. Progress heartbeats continue to work. Video-specific module access suspended; other platform functionality unaffected. Monitor vimeo.com/status .
Payment processor outage	New activations paused. Existing learners unaffected. Monitor provider status; activate alternative payment method if outage exceeds 24 hours.

5. BACKUP STRATEGY

- Database backups: automated daily backup managed by Replit infrastructure (accessible via Replit dashboard 'Database Backups'); additional manual Google Sheet export performed weekly and saved to Google Drive.
- Code and configuration: all code version-controlled in Git via Replit's built-in checkpoint history; repository should additionally be pushed to an external Git host (GitHub or GitLab) as an offline copy.
- Environment secrets: stored in Replit Secrets and additionally documented in a secure, offline, access-controlled record (e.g. password manager or sealed physical document).
- Static assets (PDFs, course materials): backed up weekly to a separate cloud storage location.
- Backup integrity: restoration test conducted quarterly; results logged in the admin dashboard (Data & Backup 'Log Restore Test').

6. COMMUNICATION PLAN

During a disruptive event, communications are managed as follows:

AUDIENCE — TIMESCALE	COMMUNICATION METHOD
Active learners — within 2 hours of declaring an incident affecting access	In-platform banner and/or direct email
New purchasers (activation failing) — within 4 hours	Automated response; manual follow-up email
IIRSM / RoSPA (if prolonged outage) — within 24 hours if outage exceeds MTD	Direct contact via info@chainsawcourses.com
ICO (if data breach) — within 72 hours	ICO online reporting portal (ico.org.uk/report-a-breach)

7. PLAN TESTING AND REVIEW

This plan is reviewed annually and tested at least every 2 years via tabletop exercise. Key test scenarios include: database restoration from backup; platform rollback following a failed deployment; and simulated loss-of-access scenario for sole director. Test outcomes are documented and any gaps are raised as improvement actions. This plan is controlled under reference QMS-006.

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